RIFLEMAN'S KIT

Many riflemen from Virginia and other frontier colonies who fought in the American Revolutionary War were incorporated into units of Washington's army and exchanged their fringed hunting shirts for more conventional uniforms. Others, such as Daniel Morgan's regiment that fought at the battle of Saratoga in 1777 retained their independent spirit along with their own clothing and equipment, fighting as skirmishers and skilled sharpshooters thanks to the accuracy of their long rifles.



Felt hat
The riflemen's flamboyant headgear reflected their life spent hunting. Instead of feathers, many riflemen decorated their hats with animal tails.

Dyed feather

Upturned brim, so rifle could be carried over the shoulder

Ramrod

Hunting shirt
Frontier riflemen did not have a uniform as such, but many favoured this style of fringed linen shirt worn with a belt fastened around the waist. The shirts were often dyed in natural shades of brown or green that acted as camouflage.

Powder horn
Riflemen did not use paper cartridges, so had to measure out both the main charge, which was poured down the muzzle, and the small quantity of primer tipped into the pan. In addition to a powder horn, many carried a small measure that held the correct amount of powder for the main charge.

Wooden stopper

Axe blade is standard British military issue of the time

Hatchet
The rifleman was a skilled hunter and woodsman and usually carried a hatchet tucked into his belt for constructing shelters and making fires.